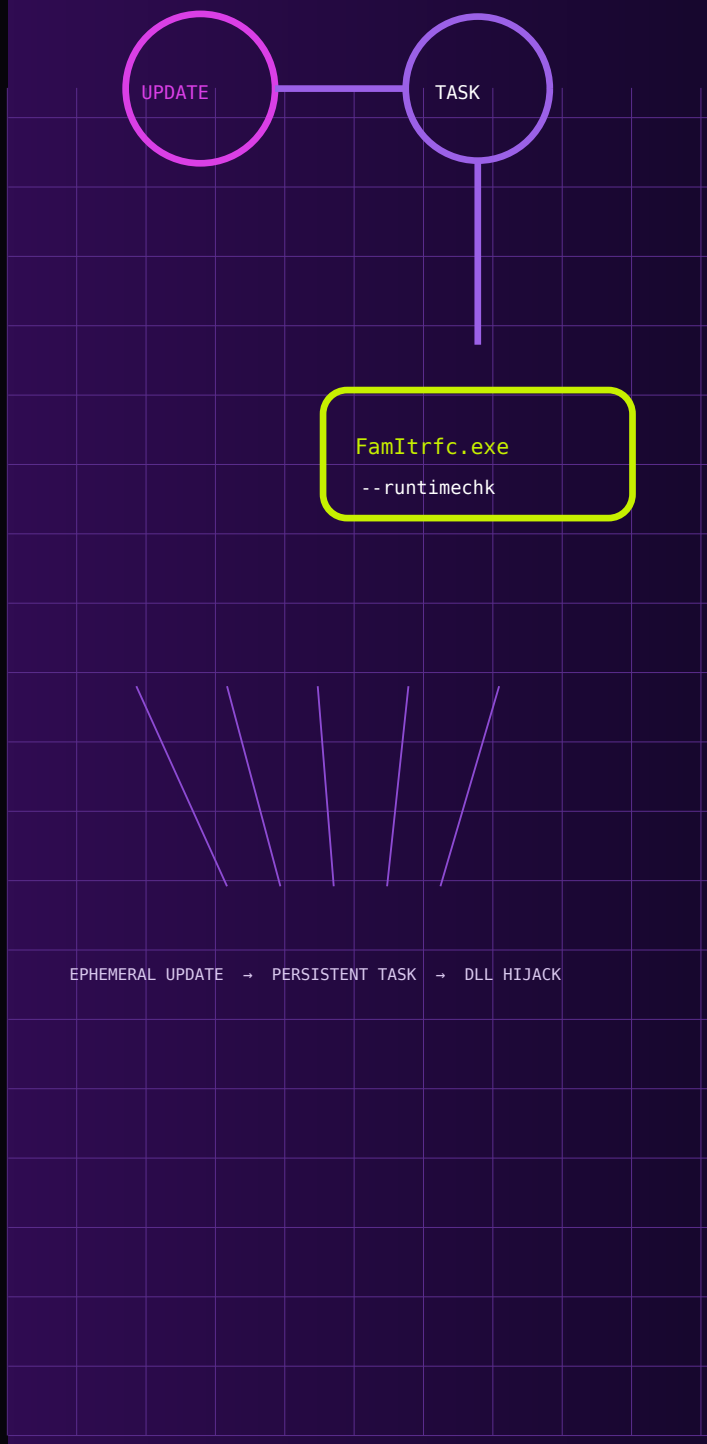
DETECTION THREAT LANDSCAPE

UNC7017 RADMIN TASK PERSISTENCE

A campaign-specific hunt for scheduled execution of the signed Radmin binary with the CROSSROAD runtime flag.



HUNTING QUERY

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

GTIG / MANDIANT · WINDOWS · UNC7017

17 OCTOBER 2026

EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT

Decision, confidence and evidence boundary.

OPERATIONAL VALUE

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The execution artifact survives restoration of the compromised update servers and can identify endpoints retaining UNC7017 persistence after the April-July delivery windows.

CLASSIFICATION

Hunting query — Untested implementation sketch

Campaign-specific artifact logic. Medium confidence until endpoint coverage and legitimate Radmin executions with the same path and flag are measured.

EVIDENCE BOUNDARY

What a match proves

A match proves execution of the source-observed Radmin runtime form. It does not prove task creation, DLL hijacking, successful C2, supply-chain delivery or attribution.

BEHAVIOR AND EVIDENCE

Source facts separated from interpretation and inference.

- **Source facts**
  GTIG and Mandiant observed CROSSROAD create RadminComponentRuntime, executing %LOCALAPPDATA%\Radmin\FamItrfc.exe --runtimechk every three hours. FamItrf2.exe is documented as an alternative.
- **Vendor interpretation**
  The signed Radmin binary is abused for DLL search-order hijacking of unsigned BlkScrDl.dll and starts the SHINYROAD chain.
- **Analyst inference**
  The exact filename, LocalAppData Radmin path and --runtimechk flag support retrospective exposure hunting.
- **Assumptions**
  Defender for Endpoint records complete path and command line for the execution.
- **Unconfirmed**
  Task provenance, malicious DLL loading, C2 success and UNC7017 attribution are not established by the process event alone.

TELEMETRY CONTRACT

Required fields, enrichment and known gaps.

REQUIRED TELEMETRY

Microsoft Defender for Endpoint process creation

DeviceProcessEvents on Windows endpoints. FolderPath and ProcessCommandLine must be populated for FamItrfc.exe and FamItrf2.exe executions.

REQUIRED FIELDS

Documented schema

Timestamp, DeviceId, DeviceName, FileName, FolderPath, ProcessCommandLine and ReportId. AccountName and InitiatingProcess* fields are optional investigation context.

UNAVAILABLE FROM THIS EVENT

Do not overclaim

Task definition, DLL signature and module load, configuration contents, network outcome and supply-chain provenance are unavailable from the process event alone.

PRIMARY KQL

Microsoft Defender XDR advanced hunting.

```
DeviceProcessEvents
| where FileName in~ ("FamItrfc.exe", "FamItrf2.exe")
| where FolderPath contains @"\AppData\Local\Radmin\"
| where ProcessCommandLine contains "--runtimechk"
| project Timestamp, DeviceId, DeviceName, AccountName,
          FileName, FolderPath, ProcessCommandLine,
          InitiatingProcessFileName,
          InitiatingProcessCommandLine, ReportId
| order by Timestamp desc
```

No threshold, aggregation, sequence or join is used. Every predicate is directly source-supported. The query avoids C2 IPs and hashes but remains campaign-specific because filename, path and flag are mutable.

TRIAGE AND TUNING

Expected overlap, exclusions and failure modes.

- **Expected false positives**
  A legitimate Radmin installation or administrative package may use the vendor binary and runtime-check flag. The LocalAppData deployment context requires owner validation.
- **Tuning**
  Allowlist only verified software distributions after checking signer, deployment owner, task definition and adjacent DLLs. Do not suppress all Radmin use.
- **Investigation**
  Inspect RadminComponentRuntime, BlkScrDl.dll signature, config.zip, RuntimeComponent.dll, parentage and adjacent network events.
- **Failure conditions**
  Sensor absent, command line missing, renamed executable, alternate path, task not triggered during retention, or payload removed before collection.
- **Durability**
  High-value retrospective exposure hunt, but less durable than behavior-only logic because filename, path and flag are mutable campaign artifacts.

VALIDATION GATES

Success, rejection and promotion criteria.

- **1 · Schema**
  Confirm DeviceProcessEvents receives Windows process creation with populated FolderPath and ProcessCommandLine for signed Radmin executables.
- **2 · Positive test**
  In an isolated lab, copy a benign signed Radmin binary to a LocalAppData Radmin directory and invoke it with --runtimechk without campaign DLLs.
- **3 · Negative baseline**
  Search the available April-July retention and current period; validate every match with software and endpoint owners.
- **Success**
  The controlled event matches and legitimate uses can be bounded by verified deployment metadata.
- **Rejection**
  Required fields are absent, the test is not returned, or approved Radmin deployments frequently reproduce the exact path and flag.
- **Secondary platforms**
  Splunk and Chronicle require a verified endpoint parser, raw sample and path/command-line mapping before any atomic query can be written reliably.

CONCLUSION AND REFERENCES

Defensible scope and source record.

VERDICT

High-value campaign-specific hunt

Run across the full April-July campaign window where retention permits. Promotion requires proof that benign Radmin activity cannot reproduce the exact path and flag at material volume.

PRIMARY TECHNICAL RESEARCH

Google Threat Intelligence Group / Mandiant — Investigating Ephemeral Supply Chain Tampering — published 15 October 2026; observed activity April-July 2026.

`hxxps://cloud[.]google[.]com/blog/topics/threat-intelligence/investigating-ephemeral-supply-chain-tampering`

OFFICIAL SCHEMA

Microsoft Learn — DeviceProcessEvents table in the advanced hunting schema — accessed 17 October 2026.

`hxxps://learn[.]microsoft[.]com/en-us/defender-xdr/advanced-hunting-deviceprocessevents-table`

ATT&CK

T1053.005 — Scheduled Task/Job: Scheduled Task. The hunt observes task-triggered execution, not task creation itself.